

Installing Claude Code

Claude Code is simple to install - whether you want to use it in your terminal, on the web, or in your IDE.

Terminal · Visual Studio Code · JetBrains · Desktop · Web

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01 Terminal

On macOS, Linux, or WSL, you can install Claude Code in one go with the `curl` command below. If you prefer Homebrew, you can use `brew install` instead - though note that this method doesn't support auto-updates.

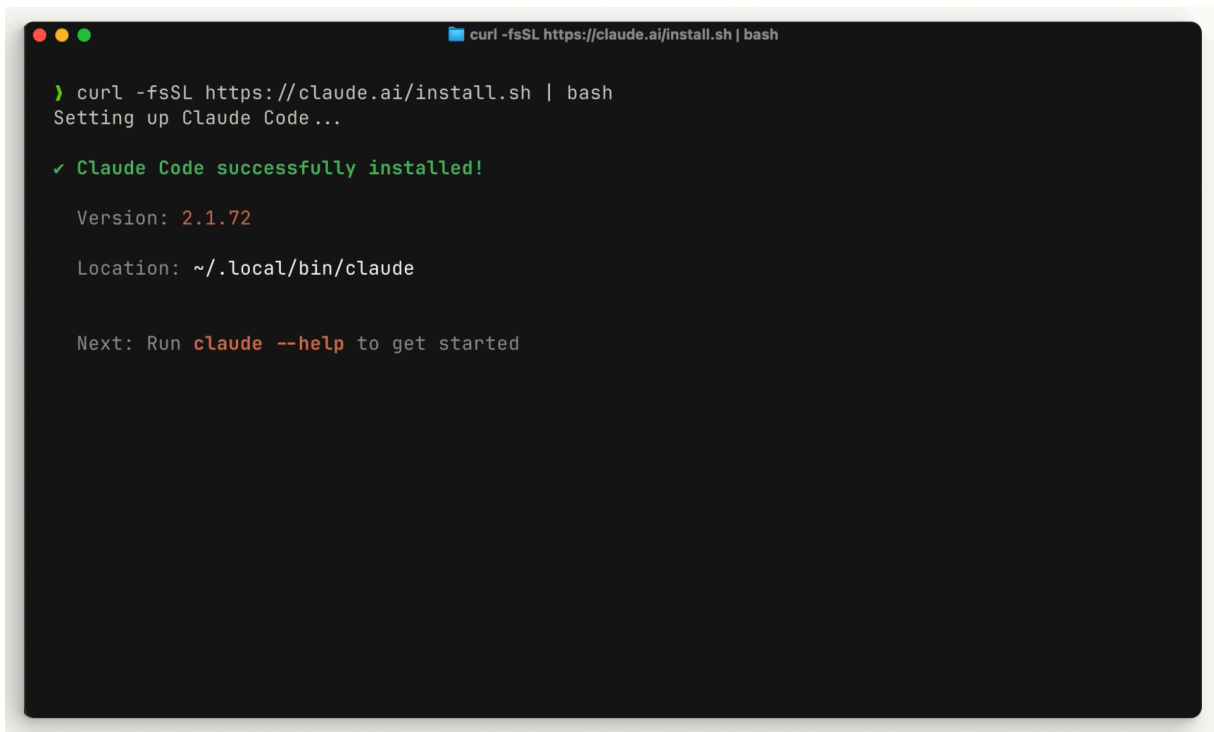
```
BASH
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

On Windows, you have a few options. In PowerShell, use the `Invoke-RestMethod` command; in Command Prompt, use `curl`. There's also a `winget` command available, though - like Homebrew - it won't auto-update.

Platform	Install method	Auto-updates
macOS / Linux / WSL	<code>curl</code> install script	Yes

Platform	Install method	Auto-updates
macOS / Linux	Homebrew - <code>brew install</code>	No
Windows · PowerShell	<code>Invoke-WebRequest</code>	Yes
Windows · CMD	<code>curl</code>	Yes
Windows	<code>winget</code>	No

“Yes” means the installer keeps Claude Code updated automatically; “No” means you’ll update it manually.



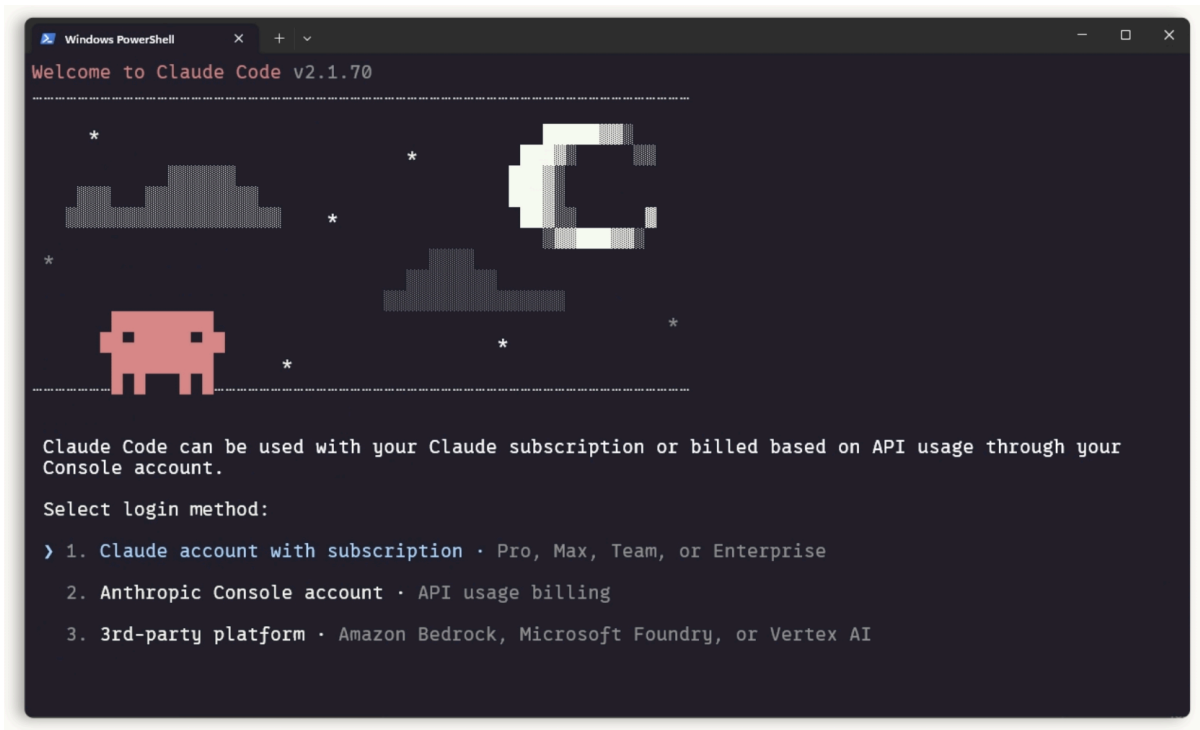
macOS / Linux - Claude Code installed via the curl script and ready to run.

Run Claude Code

After installation, you should be able to run the `claude` command. If it isn’t found, restart your terminal. Then navigate to your project directory and run:

```
BASH
claude
```

You'll go through a few setup steps - choosing a color theme and signing in with your Claude account (Pro, Max, or Enterprise) or an API key.



The first launch walks you through theme selection and choosing how to sign in.

ENTERPRISE ACCOUNTS

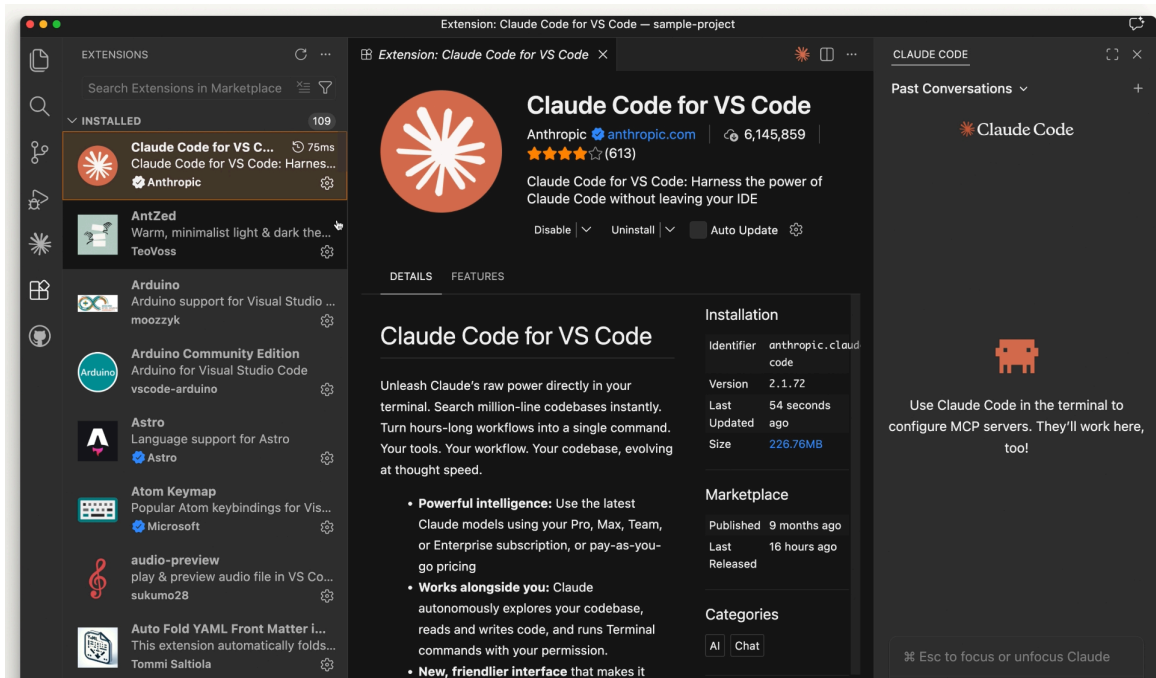
If your organization has a Claude Enterprise account, be sure to select that option when you sign in.

MIND YOUR WORKING DIRECTORY

Claude Code can access whatever directory you launch it in - including all of its subfolders. Start it from the right project root.

02 Visual Studio Code

Open the Extensions panel and search for "Claude Code." Look for the extension published by Anthropic with the blue verification check, then click **Install**.



The official Claude Code extension for VS Code, published by Anthropic.

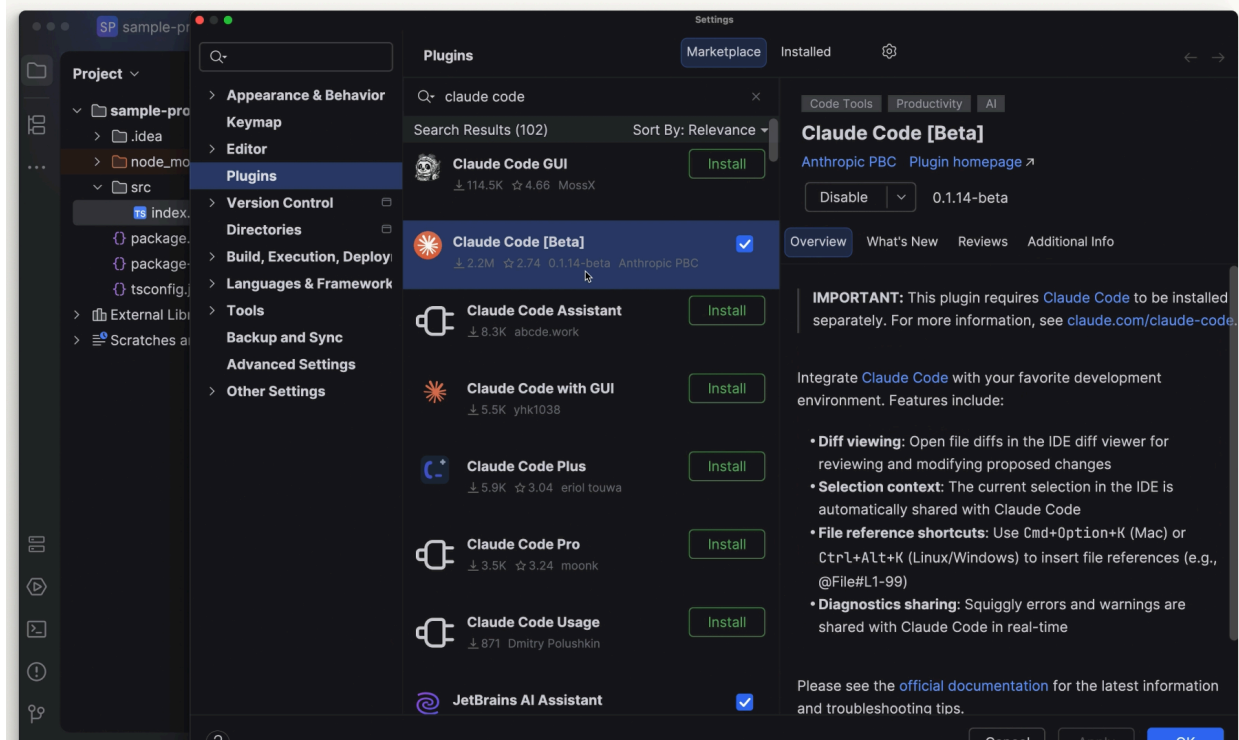
After installing, you may need to restart VS Code. Once it's running, open the command palette with `Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + P` and search for “Claude Code: Open in New Tab.” You can also click the Claude logo in your sidebar.

PREFER THE TERMINAL FEEL?

The VS Code extension offers an experience very similar to the terminal. If you'd rather use the terminal directly, you can opt out of the UI in the extension's settings.

03 JetBrains

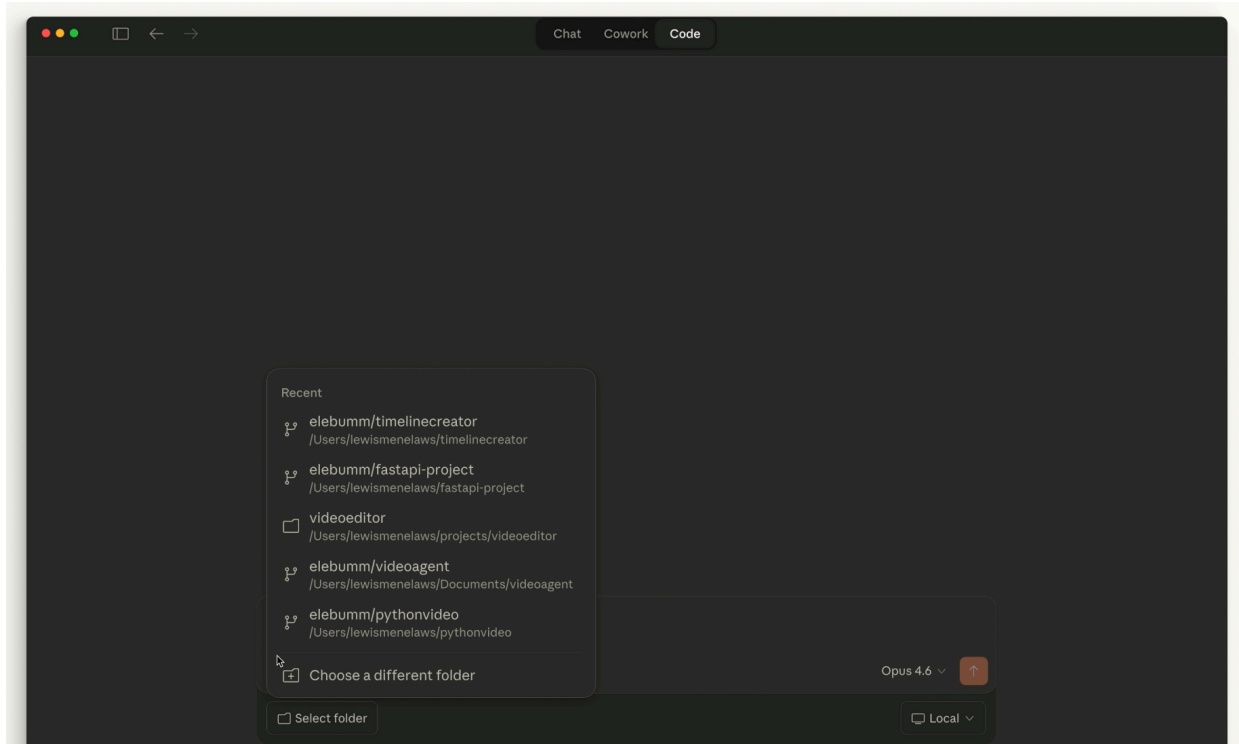
Install the Claude Code plugin from the JetBrains Marketplace, then restart your IDE. When you reopen it, you'll see the Claude logo - click it to open a pane with the terminal experience right alongside your editor.



Claude Code in the JetBrains Marketplace, ready to install.

04 Desktop

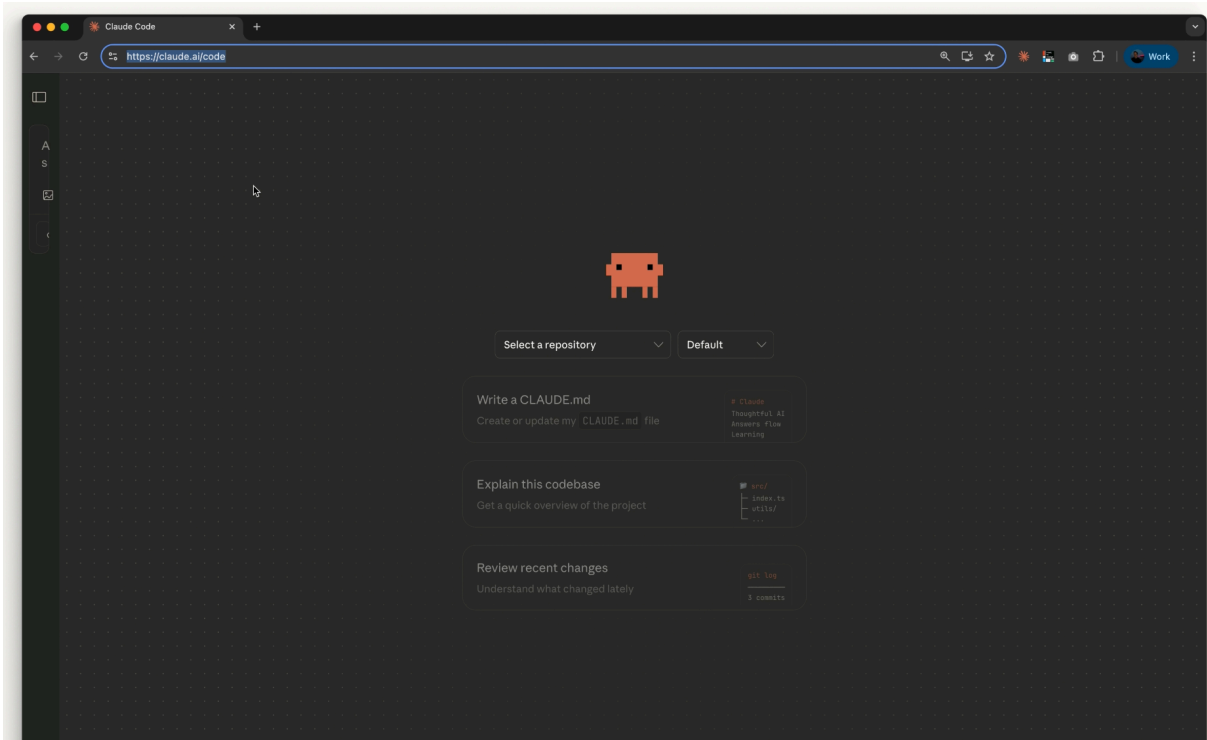
After installing and signing in to Claude Desktop, you'll see a toggle at the top labeled "Code." It looks and feels much like the chat experience, but it lets you work in a specific folder, change permissions, and even work in a cloud environment.



Switch to “Code” in Claude Desktop, then pick a folder to work in.

05 Web

On the web, open Claude Code at `claude.ai/code`, or click the “Code” label in the sidebar of the chat app. It works much like the desktop app, with one difference: you’re limited to GitHub repositories.



Claude Code on the web - select a GitHub repository to get started.

06 Which One Should I Use?

Every option lands you in the same Claude Code experience, so the right choice mostly comes down to where you like to work. If you want to stay on the cutting edge, the terminal is your best bet - new features ship there first. The IDE integrations offer a nearly identical experience if you'd rather keep Claude Code woven into your editor. Desktop is great for letting Claude work in the background while you handle other tasks, and the web is a solid option for working remotely through a GitHub repository.

If you want to...	Recommended
Stay on the cutting edge (new features land first)	Terminal
Keep Claude woven into your code editor	VS Code or JetBrains
Let Claude work in the background on other tasks	Desktop
Work remotely on a GitHub repository	Web (claude.ai/code)

However you want to use Claude Code - the choice is yours.